

Ricardo Varela

Project Controls & PMO Analyst · Industrial Engineer

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Status: EU (Italian) and Canadian citizen, no sponsorship needed · Available before January 2027 · Open to relocation

Profile

Industrial engineer who keeps projects on budget and on schedule by making the numbers trustworthy: tracking progress, reconciling month-end costs, and reporting to decision-makers. Experience across banking, rail and defence at CIBC, Hitachi Rail and Thales, working with SAP cost data, Excel/VBA, Tableau and Power BI. Currently adding applied AI at George Brown Polytechnic to automate project tracking and reporting.

Work experience

AI Developer, Industry-Sponsored Capstone Aug 2026 – Present
Kinectrics, Toronto, Ontario

- **Time series analysis:** exploring and analyzing time series data under the guidance of a Kinectrics industry supervisor to identify patterns and inform model development.
- **Cross-organizational collaboration:** working directly with an industry supervisor at Kinectrics to align project direction with real-world data.

AI Developer, Faculty-Supervised Academic Project Aug 2026 – Present
George Brown Polytechnic, Toronto, Ontario

- **Application development:** building a React Native mobile app that turns voice recordings and podcast audio into video content using AI.
- **AI integration:** integrating speech processing and generative AI models to convert audio into synchronized visual and video output.
- **Project execution:** leading design and development, including UX decisions and technical architecture, with regular guidance from a faculty supervisor.

Project Coordinator, Business Effectiveness Oct 2024 – Sep 2025
CIBC, Toronto, Ontario

- **Portfolio oversight:** tracked progress on 20+ active projects valued at over \$1M.
- **Data integrity:** consolidated and reconciled month-end cost data across the portfolio for accuracy and timely reporting.
- **Stakeholder reporting:** delivered monthly performance and financial presentations using Excel Pivot Tables and Tableau.
- **Cross-team collaboration:** worked with 11+ project managers to keep cost estimates current across all initiatives.
- **Automation:** streamlined recurring processes using Excel and VBA, consistently delivering within tight deadlines while maintaining high accuracy.

Procurement Office Intern Apr 2024 – Sep 2024
Hitachi Rail GTS Canada, Toronto, Ontario

- **SAP and cost data:** worked hands-on with SAP (cost centers, internal orders, profitability-related data) alongside a structured database for tracking orders, pricing, and historical quotes on international projects.
- **Automated workflows:** used Excel macros and VBA to boost task efficiency across departments.
- **Vendor management:** validated supplier information and maintained accurate purchase order records.

Global Project Management Office Intern May 2022 – Sep 2022
Thales, Toronto, Ontario

- **SAP data support:** used SAP for data entry and lookup to support international project tracking, organizing and analyzing data for data-informed decisions.
- **Reporting:** used Excel and Power BI for analysis, strengthening client service and decision-making.

Projects

Earned-Value Project Controls Dashboard

In progress

- SQL database of synthetic project data feeding a Power BI dashboard: budget vs. actual, CPI and SPI per project, earned-value S-curves, and an estimate-at-completion forecast.

Invoice OCR & Computer Vision Pipeline

George Brown Polytechnic · team project

- CNN and SSD-style region detection (IoU-evaluated), OCR on detected regions, and extraction of payment terms and due dates into a structured JSON record. Served with FastAPI and Streamlit, containerized with Docker on a GCP Compute Engine VM. github.com/RV922/DL2_InvoiceAI

Fraud Detection in E-Commerce Transactions

University of Toronto

- Built and evaluated a machine learning classification model to flag fraudulent transaction patterns.

Automation for Mushroom Farming Operations (Capstone)

University of Windsor

- Designed an automation system for mushroom farming operations.

OpenClaw Hack, Toronto Students & Alumni Hackathon

May 2025

- Built at the Daphne Cockwell Complex alongside Toronto's student and alumni developer community.

Other coursework: Personalized Medical Recommendation System (Random Forest and decision trees served via Flask API, UofT) · Climate Impact on Wine Quality & Price (ETL of 130,000+ records with climate API data into SQL, UofT) · Crowdfunding Database (ETL into a relational database, UofT) · Control System Design in MATLAB & Simulink (Windsor) · Training Robot Operations (Windsor)

Skills

Project controls & business systems: SAP (cost centers, internal orders, profitability data), Excel / VBA, Jira, Power BI, Tableau

Data & analytics: SQL, Python, PySpark, Databricks, MongoDB

Software development: Flask, C++, Java

Education

Applied A.I. Solutions Development

Jan 2026 – Present

George Brown Polytechnic, Toronto, Ontario · 93/100 GPA

Data Analytics Postgraduate Studies

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

University of Toronto, Toronto, Ontario

B.A.Sc., Industrial Engineering

Sep 2018 – Apr 2023

University of Windsor, Windsor, Ontario · Minor in Business Administration & Mathematics

Languages & additional

Languages: English (fluent), Spanish (fluent), Italian (basic, learning), French (basic, learning)

Additional: Head of House, Student Residence, University of Windsor (2022–23) · Swimming Instructor & Lifeguard, YMCA Toronto (2019)